Alfonso Manuel Baena González



Platform Engineer · Data Architect

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About

Platform Engineer with a strong background as Data Architect and Analytics Engineer. Focused on building platform foundations mainly on AWS: GitOps and everything-as-code platform-based fan and strong focus on DevEx and team autonomy. Brings deep data domain knowledge to the platform: Modern Data Stack, Data Mesh and data governance. Experience in leadership, mentoring and strategic business thinking, and lately, a little obsessed with the new agentic "era".

"Always curious, always learning"

Experience

Next Digital Hub — 2024 - Actual

Data Architect - Platform Engineer

- Defined data governance for a data platform serving over +150 data engineers and analysts, following data mesh principles.
- Led the decision-making process for the platform’s data governance tool (DataHub, OpenMetadata), including its design, deployment, and implementation on AWS.
- Contributed to defining and adopting the platform's IaC approach with Atlantis for PR-driven Terraform workflows.
- Deployed and operated platform workloads on Kubernetes (EKS) following GitOps with ArgoCD.
- Drove agentic engineering adoption on the platform
- Led proof-of-concepts with new technologies and defined their adoption focusing on cost improvements and transitioning to a modern data stack and serverless approach.
- Created documentation and defined frameworks for batch processing methodologies, following DevOps/GitOps philosophies to ensure developer efficiency and experience.

Next Digital Hub — 2021 - 2024

Senior Data Engineer - Tech Lead

- Led a squad of Data Engineers/Analysts.
- Gathered requirements, designed end-to-end data products and collaborated with cross-functional teams.
- Led dbt standardization (structure, testing, TDD, integrations, and deployment) and promoted the adoption.
- ETL/ELT processes using dbt, airflow, AWS (Redshift, S3, EKS, ECS, EMR...) and visualized in PowerBI service.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines using Gitlab reducing times from minutes to seconds while reducing costs.
- Mentored and participated in the technical selection of data engineers.
- Experience in a 24/7 on-call support team with over 20 critical services from Iberia Data Platform.

Future Connections 2019 - 2021

Data Engineer

- Developed multiple use cases (including geospatial analysis) on T-Mobile's Big Data platform using PySpark/Hive, in addition to python/bash in a non-distributed way.
- Migrated the data orchestration from NiFi to Airflow, including deploying and maintaining the Airflow infrastructure.
- Participated in churn detection and clustering projects using PySpark and MLlib.
- Provided infrastructure, including EC2 and RDS on AWS, for cloud-based data processing.
- Administered and maintained Linux on-premises systems, ELK stack deployment and develop on it (also relational databases, Kibana...).

Dekra 2018 - 2019

RF Engineer - Trainee

- Automated manual processes with Python/Bash and web-scraping.
- Performed software and hardware radiofrequency tests on mobile devices (3G, 4G).

Education

- **Bachelor Degree in Telecommunication Technologies Engineering** @ University of Malaga - UMA
- **Cambridge English: Preliminary (PET)** @ University of Cambridge

Relevant Certifications

- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
- AWS Certified Developer – Associate
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate
- AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate
- AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate
- AWS Certified Data Analytics – Specialty
- ClickHouse Certified Developer
- Professional Scrum Master™ I (PSM I)
- dbt Analytics Engineering Certification
- 2x Astronomer Certification for Apache Airflow
- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate (003)

Skills

Python SQL Bash AWS Terraform Kubernetes GitOps Docker Observability Agentic Engineering Airflow dbt Spark Data Governance Leadership Mentorship